

Line List Preparation — Practical Study Guide

A field-oriented reference covering the core engineering topics in piping line list preparation — combining ASME B31.3 and standard piping engineering practice with worked sample calculations, sample datasheets, and design-basis assumptions drawn from real project execution. This guide is a companion to the **Flare Network Design**, **Depressurization Calculation**, and **Compressor Settle-Out Calculations** study guides — the line list is the document that ultimately records and carries forward the design pressures/temperatures those other studies establish.

Illustrative project used throughout this guide: a 6-inch carbon steel pump discharge line from a suction vessel to a downstream vessel, used to work through design pressure/temperature determination, piping class assignment, wall thickness calculation, and personnel-protection insulation sizing. All numbers below are worked sample calculations for study purposes — always replace with project-specific equipment data and the project piping material specification (PMS).

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1. Design Basis & Assumptions

Line list preparation is normally governed by a "**Piping Material Specification (PMS)**" and a "**Line Designation / Numbering Philosophy**", both issued and frozen early — the line list itself is a living document (revised through the project), but the *rules* it's built on should not change mid-project without a controlled revision, since every downstream discipline (stress, materials, procurement, construction) works directly off the line list.

1.1 Project & Equipment Basis (illustrative project)

Parameter	Value	Notes
Line	6"-P-1042-A1A-H	Pump discharge, V-100 to V-200
Fluid	Light hydrocarbon liquid, $\rho \approx 850 \text{ kg/m}^3$	—
Source equipment	Pump P-101 A/B (centrifugal)	Suction from V-100
Pump rated differential	250 psi at rated flow	From pump datasheet
Pump shutoff (dead-head) differential	$1.15 \times$ rated (typical centrifugal)	Confirm actual curve — do not assume a generic factor without vendor data
Normal suction pressure	20 psig	—
Downstream PSV set pressure	275 psig	On V-200 inlet piping
Destination equipment	V-200, MAWP 300 psig	—
Normal operating temperature	150 °F (65.6 °C)	—
Site minimum design ambient temperature	−20 °F (−28.9 °C)	Governs MDMT/impact-test screening
Elevation change, pump discharge to V-200 inlet	+25 m (line runs uphill)	Governs static head correction
Pipe size (assumed)	6-inch, Schedule 40	To be confirmed by wall thickness calc
Material	ASTM A106 Grade B, seamless, CS	Standard PMS default for this service class

1.2 Codes & Standards / Methodology Basis

- **ASME B31.3** — Process Piping (design pressure/temperature, wall thickness, MDMT/impact-test exemption methodology)
- **ASME B16.5 / B16.34** — flange and valve pressure-temperature ratings
- **ASME B36.10M** — standard pipe wall thickness/schedule designations
- **Project Piping Material Specification (PMS)** — governs where stricter than code minimums (e.g., house corrosion allowance, minimum wall thickness by size, mandatory PWHT thresholds)

- Company/client line designation and line list procedure — governs field naming/numbering conventions

1.3 Key Design Assumptions (typical, to be confirmed per project)

Assumption	Typical Value	Basis / Justification
Design pressure margin over normal operating pressure	Greater of +10% or +25 psi (client-specific, confirm actual rule)	Common industry default; some clients use different margins by service
Design temperature margin over normal operating temperature	+25 °F (or per client PMS)	Accounts for upset/startup excursions
Corrosion allowance (CS, general hydrocarbon service)	1/16 in (1.5 mm)	Project PMS; can be higher for sour/erosive service
Mill under-tolerance (seamless pipe)	12.5%	ASME B36.10M / API 5L manufacturing tolerance
Static head correction	Applied per elevation difference between reference point and connected equipment	Frequently missed on lines with significant elevation change — see Calc Sheet 9.1
Personnel-protection insulation touch-temperature limit	140 °F (60 °C) surface temperature	Common industry/OSHA-referenced touch-safety threshold; confirm project HSE standard
MDMT impact-test exemption methodology	ASME B31.3 Fig. 323.2.2A/B (basic curve + stress-ratio reduction)	See Calc Sheet 9.2

 **Practical note:** The design pressure/temperature margin rules (Section 1.3) are exactly the kind of assumption that varies by client and is easy to get wrong by defaulting to "whatever the last project used" — always confirm the actual project basis of design (BOD) or piping design philosophy document before populating the line list, since this single rule affects every line on the list.

2. Fundamentals & Purpose of the Line List

2.1 What the Line List Is

The line list is the **master register of every piping line** in a project, uniquely identifying each line and recording the data needed to design, procure, fabricate, inspect, and operate it

— size, material/piping class, design conditions, insulation, tracing, corrosion allowance, test pressure, and more.

2.2 Why It Matters

- It is the **single source of truth** that piping stress engineers, materials engineers, procurement, fabrication, and construction all work from — an error or omission on the line list propagates directly into isometrics, material take-offs, and ultimately the as-built plant.
- It is the document where the design pressures/temperatures established by process, relief, and settle-out studies (see the companion guides in this series) are **formally recorded and carried forward** into piping design — the line list is where those upstream calculations become an actionable, traceable engineering record.
- It supports **Management of Change (MOC)** — any change to a line's service, size, or design condition should be traceable through a controlled line list revision, not an informal note on an isometric.

3. Line Numbering & Designation Philosophy

3.1 Typical Line Number Structure

A common format (project-specific — always confirm the actual convention):

6"	-	P	-	1042	-	A1A	-	H
Size		Fluid		Sequential		Piping		Insulation/
		Code		Number		Class		Tracing Code

- **Size:** Nominal pipe size (NPS)
- **Fluid/service code:** e.g., P = process, U = utility, ST = steam, CW = cooling water — project-specific legend
- **Sequential number:** Unique identifier, often area/unit-coded (e.g., 1000s block for Unit 100)
- **Piping class:** Ties directly to the PMS (material, rating, corrosion allowance — see Section 5)
- **Insulation/tracing suffix:** e.g., H = hot insulation, C = cold/personnel protection, T = heat traced

3.2 Practical Considerations

- **Sequential number blocks** should be pre-allocated by area/unit/discipline at project start to avoid renumbering conflicts as the design develops — renumbering an active line mid-project cascades into isometrics, stress models, and the material take-off, and is a common source of late-project rework.

- **Line breaks** (where the line number changes) should occur at a piping class break, a major branch, or an equipment nozzle — not arbitrarily mid-run — since the piping class boundary is what actually matters for material procurement and stress analysis.

4. Line List Data Fields & Content

A typical line list carries (at minimum) the following fields per line — see Section 10.1 for a worked sample table:

Field Category	Typical Fields
Identification	Line number, P&ID reference, from/to (equipment or line), area/unit
Sizing	Nominal size, schedule/wall thickness
Service	Fluid service, phase, hazardous service flag (toxic/flammable/sour)
Piping class	Class code, material, rating (e.g., ASME Class 150/300/600)
Design conditions	Design pressure, design temperature, MDMT
Operating conditions	Normal operating pressure/temperature (min and max if variable)
Test requirements	Hydrotest pressure, test medium, PWHT requirement
Corrosion	Corrosion allowance, corrosion loop/CML reference
Insulation/tracing	Insulation type & thickness, personnel protection flag, heat tracing type
Special requirements	X-ray/NDE percentage, PMI requirement, stress-critical flag, sour service flag

Practical tip: The **stress-critical flag** and **hazardous service flag** fields are small but high-value — they tell the stress engineering team and the QA/QC team which lines need the most rigorous review, and missing or incorrect flags are a recurring source of scope gaps discovered late (see Section 12).

5. Piping Class / Material Selection Basis

5.1 What a Piping Class Defines

A piping class (per the project PMS) bundles together, for a given pressure/temperature/service combination: base material, pressure rating (ASME B16.5 class), corrosion allowance, valve types/trim, gasket/bolting, and any special requirements (PWHT, NDE, PMI) — assigning a line to a class is a shorthand that carries all of this information at once.

5.2 Selection Logic

1. Determine the line's **design pressure and temperature** (Section 6).
2. Determine the required **material** based on service (sweet/sour, temperature range, corrosion/erosion considerations — see the companion Flow Assurance guide for corrosion/erosion screening methodology).
3. Select the **lowest-rated class** (e.g., ASME Class 150 before considering Class 300) that satisfies the design pressure/temperature at the selected material's B16.5 rating table — going to a higher class than necessary adds unnecessary cost.
4. Confirm any **service-specific overrides** in the PMS (e.g., a class might be upgraded regardless of pressure/temperature for sour service, cyclic service, or a company minimum-class policy).

5.3 Practical Tip

Piping class boundaries (e.g., ASME Class 150 vs. 300) are **temperature-dependent**, not just pressure-dependent — a line that would be Class 150 at 100°F can require Class 300 at 400°F even at the same design pressure, because B16.5 allowable pressure *decreases* with increasing temperature for a given class. Always check the class rating table at the line's actual design temperature, not just at ambient.

6. Design Pressure & Temperature Determination

6.1 Design Pressure — General Approach

Design pressure is the **highest** of several candidate values, not simply the normal operating pressure plus a flat margin:

- Upstream/downstream equipment MAWP (if directly connected without an intervening relief device)
- Pump shutoff (dead-head) pressure, for pump discharge lines
- Relief/PSV set pressure plus the code-allowed accumulation margin (commonly +10%)
- Normal operating pressure plus the project's standard margin (Section 1.3)
- **Static head correction** for elevation differences between the line's reference point and connected equipment (Calc Sheet 9.1)

6.2 Design Temperature — General Approach

- Normal operating temperature plus the project's standard margin (Section 1.3), covering credible startup/upset excursions.
- For lines exposed to solar radiation or with no active cooling at low/no-flow conditions, check whether a stagnant/no-flow case could exceed the flowing design temperature.
- **Minimum design metal temperature (MDMT)** is checked separately, against the site's minimum ambient/process temperature, using the ASME B31.3 impact-test

exemption methodology (Calc Sheet 9.2) — this determines whether the selected material requires impact (Charpy) testing.

7. Insulation, Heat Tracing & PWHT Requirements

7.1 Insulation Types & Purpose

Type	Purpose
Hot insulation (process/energy conservation)	Reduce heat loss from hot lines, maintain process temperature
Personnel protection insulation	Reduce accessible surface temperature below a touch-safety threshold (commonly 140 °F/60 °C) — see Calc Sheet 9.4
Cold/anti-sweat insulation	Prevent condensation on cold lines below ambient dew point
Acoustic insulation	Reduce noise from high-velocity/pressure-drop lines (e.g., control valve stations)

7.2 Heat Tracing

- **Electrical trace heating** or **steam tracing** maintains line temperature above a minimum (freeze protection, wax/hydrate avoidance — see the companion Flow Assurance guide, viscosity maintenance for heavy fluids, or process temperature maintenance during low/no-flow periods).
- Line list should flag tracing requirement, type, and — where available — the target maintain temperature, so the tracing design package can size cable/steam trace spacing without re-deriving the requirement from scratch.

7.3 PWHT (Post-Weld Heat Treatment)

- Required based on material, thickness, and service per ASME B31.3 (and any project PMS overrides, which are often more conservative than the code minimum — e.g., mandatory PWHT for all sour service welds regardless of thickness).
- Line list should carry a clear PWHT flag per line so fabrication planning and NDE scope are established before shop drawings are issued, not discovered during fabrication.

8. Line List Development Workflow & Interdisciplinary Coordination

8.1 Typical Workflow

1. **Process** issues P&IDs with line numbers, normal operating conditions, and preliminary line sizes.

2. **Process/Relief/Settle-Out studies** (see companion guides) establish governing design pressures/temperatures for each system.
3. **Piping/Materials** assigns piping class per the PMS logic (Section 5) and populates the line list.
4. **Stress engineering** reviews stress-critical lines (large diameter, high temperature, connected to rotating equipment) and may request line routing or support changes that feed back into the line list (e.g., a design temperature revision after a more detailed thermal analysis).
5. **Insulation/tracing/PWHT** requirements are added once process and mechanical requirements are finalized.
6. **QA/QC** issues the line list for construction, links it to the NDE/inspection plan, and manages revision control through project close-out.

8.2 Practical Coordination Tips

- The line list should be treated as **the** controlled interface document between disciplines — informal verbal agreements to change a design condition ("just make it Class 300, we'll fix the line list later") are a common source of the exact kind of mismatch described in the Case Study (Section 13).
- Any revision to a line's design pressure/temperature (e.g., following a settle-out study update, per the companion Compressor Settle-Out guide) must trigger a **line list revision with change tracking**, not a standalone email or marked-up isometric that never makes it back into the controlled document.

9. Sample Calculation Sheets

All calculations below use the illustrative project basis in Section 1. Values are for study purposes — verify against project-specific equipment datasheets and the project PMS.

9.1 Calc Sheet 1 — Design Pressure Determination (with Static Head Correction)

Given (from Section 1 basis):

- Normal suction pressure = 20 psig
- Pump rated differential = 250 psi; shutoff (dead-head) factor = 1.15
- Downstream PSV set pressure = 275 psig
- Fluid density, $\rho = 850 \text{ kg/m}^3$
- Elevation rise, pump discharge to V-200 = 25 m
- V-200 MAWP = 300 psig

Step 1 — Pump shutoff (dead-head) pressure:

Shutoff differential = $250 \times 1.15 = 287.5 \text{ psi}$

Dead-head pressure = suction pressure + shutoff differential

Dead-head pressure = $20 + 287.5 = 307.5 \text{ psig}$

Step 2 — PSV set pressure plus accumulation margin (+10%):

$$\text{PSV set} + 10\% = 275 \times 1.10 = 302.5 \text{ psig}$$

Step 3 — Governing design pressure at the reference point (pump discharge nozzle):

$$\text{Design pressure} = \max(\text{dead-head}, \text{PSV set} + 10\%) = \max(307.5, 302.5) = 307.5 \text{ psig}$$

Step 4 — Static head correction (checking the elevated destination equipment, V-200):

$$\Delta P_{\text{static}} = \rho \times g \times h$$

$$\Delta P_{\text{static}} = 850 \times 9.81 \times 25 = 208,463 \text{ Pa} = 208.5 \text{ kPa} \approx 30.2 \text{ psi}$$

Static pressure at V-200 (top of rise) under the dead-head (static, no-flow) condition:

$$P_{\text{at_V200}} = \text{Dead-head pressure} - \Delta P_{\text{static}} = 307.5 - 30.2 \approx 277.3 \text{ psig}$$

Step 5 — Check against V-200 MAWP:

$$P_{\text{at_V200}} (277.3 \text{ psig}) < \text{V-200 MAWP} (300 \text{ psig}) \rightarrow \text{PASS}$$

Result: Line design pressure (at the pump discharge reference point) = **307.5 psig**, rounded to **310 psig** per standard line list rounding practice (or the project's specific rounding convention). The static head correction confirms V-200 is adequately protected under the dead-head condition without requiring a lower line design pressure or additional relief device — but the **line itself** must still be rated for 307.5 psig along its full length, since that is the maximum pressure it will see at the low (pump discharge) end.

✦ **Assumption check:** This example credited static head to *relieve* pressure at the elevated destination — the opposite direction (checking a line that runs *downhill* from source to destination) would instead require *adding* static head to the design pressure at the low point. Always work out the actual direction of elevation change for each line rather than applying a memorized "add" or "subtract" rule.

9.2 Calc Sheet 2 — MDMT / Impact-Test Exemption Screening (ASME B31.3)

Given:

- Material: ASTM A106 Grade B, seamless (Curve B per B31.3 Fig. 323.2.2A)
- Nominal wall thickness (Schedule 40, 6-in): $t = 0.280$ in
- Design pressure, $P = 310$ psig (from Calc Sheet 9.1, rounded)
- Pipe OD, $D = 6.625$ in

- Allowable stress at design temperature, $S = 20,000$ psi (illustrative — confirm actual value from B31.3 Table A-1 at the line's design temperature)
- Site minimum design metal temperature = -20 °F (Section 1.1 basis)

Step 1 — Calculate the design hoop stress:

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma &= P \times D / (2 \times t) \\ \sigma &= 310 \times 6.625 / (2 \times 0.280) \\ \sigma &= 2,053.8 / 0.560 \\ \sigma &\approx 3,668 \text{ psi}\end{aligned}$$

Step 2 — Calculate the stress ratio, R_s (design stress ÷ allowable stress):

$$R_s = \sigma / S = 3,668 / 20,000 \approx 0.183$$

Step 3 — Basic minimum temperature from Curve B (illustrative chart read, B31.3 Fig. 323.2.2A):

For 0.280 in wall thickness, Curve B basic minimum temperature ≈ -20 °F

Step 4 — Apply the stress-ratio-based temperature reduction (illustrative chart read, Fig. 323.2.2B):

For $R_s \approx 0.18-0.20$, allowable temperature reduction ≈ 50 °F (read from chart)
Reduced exemption temperature = -20 °F $- 50$ °F = -70 °F

Step 5 — Compare to site minimum design metal temperature:

Site MDMT (-20 °F) > Reduced exemption temperature (-70 °F) → PASS

Result: Because the line operates at a low stress ratio (design stress is only ~18% of allowable), the B31.3 stress-ratio reduction credit lowers the impact-test exemption temperature to -70 °F, comfortably below the site's -20 °F minimum design metal temperature — **impact (Charpy) testing is not required** for this line's material at this thickness.

✦ **Assumption check:** This calc sheet illustrates the *method* — the actual Curve A/B/C/D basic temperature and the stress-ratio reduction value must be read from the current edition of ASME B31.3 Fig. 323.2.2A/B (or an equivalent validated software tool) using the line's actual wall thickness and stress ratio, not assumed from this example. This exemption credit is one of the most valuable (and most often under-utilized) tools in piping material selection for cold-climate projects — a line that appears to require

impact-tested material at first glance can often be exempted once the actual stress ratio is calculated, avoiding unnecessary cost.

9.3 Calc Sheet 3 — Pressure Design (Wall) Thickness (ASME B31.3)

Given (carried from Calc Sheets 9.1–9.2):

- Design pressure, $P = 310$ psig
- Pipe OD, $D = 6.625$ in
- Allowable stress, $S = 20,000$ psi
- Weld joint efficiency, $E = 1.0$ (seamless)
- Coefficient, $Y = 0.4$ (ferritic steel, $t < D/6$, temperature < 900 °F)
- Corrosion allowance, $CA = 0.0625$ in (Section 1.3 basis)
- Mill under-tolerance = 12.5% (seamless pipe)

Step 1 — Pressure design thickness (B31.3 straight pipe formula):

$$\begin{aligned}t &= (P \times D) / [2 \times (S \times E + P \times Y)] \\t &= (310 \times 6.625) / [2 \times (20,000 \times 1.0 + 310 \times 0.4)] \\t &= 2,053.8 / [2 \times (20,000 + 124)] \\t &= 2,053.8 / 40,248 \\t &\approx 0.0510 \text{ in}\end{aligned}$$

Step 2 — Add corrosion allowance:

$$t + CA = 0.0510 + 0.0625 = 0.1135 \text{ in}$$

Step 3 — Apply mill under-tolerance to determine minimum nominal (purchase) thickness:

$$\begin{aligned}t_{\text{nominal}} &= (t + CA) / (1 - 0.125) \\t_{\text{nominal}} &= 0.1135 / 0.875 \\t_{\text{nominal}} &\approx 0.1297 \text{ in}\end{aligned}$$

Step 4 — Compare to standard Schedule 40 wall thickness (6-in NPS):

Schedule 40 nominal wall = 0.280 in
Required minimum (calculated) = 0.130 in
Schedule 40 (0.280 in) >> Required minimum (0.130 in) → PASS with significant margin

Result: Schedule 40 is **more than adequate** for pure pressure-containment purposes on this line — the calculated minimum required thickness (≈ 0.130 in) is less than half of

Schedule 40's actual wall (0.280 in). In practice, Schedule 40 (or the project PMS's standard minimum wall for this size) is still selected, because piping class minimum-thickness rules are very often governed by **mechanical robustness, erosion allowance, and standardization practice**, not by the pressure design calculation alone.

✦ **Practical note:** This is a common and useful finding to document explicitly on a line list review — it confirms the selected schedule is not marginal, and it also flags that a lighter (and cheaper) schedule *could* be justified by pressure alone if the project's minimum-wall policy allowed it, which is sometimes worth raising during a cost-optimization value-engineering pass on high-quantity bulk piping.

9.4 Calc Sheet 4 — Personnel Protection Insulation Thickness

Given:

- Pipe OD, $D = 6.625 \text{ in} \rightarrow$ outer radius, $r_1 = 3.3125 \text{ in} = 0.2760 \text{ ft}$
- Process (pipe) temperature, $T_{\text{pipe}} = 250 \text{ }^\circ\text{F}$
- Ambient (design, summer) temperature, $T_{\text{amb}} = 80 \text{ }^\circ\text{F}$
- Touch-safety target surface temperature, $T_{\text{surface}} = 140 \text{ }^\circ\text{F}$ (Section 1.3 basis)
- Insulation thermal conductivity, $k = 0.032 \text{ Btu}/(\text{hr}\cdot\text{ft}\cdot^\circ\text{F})$ (mineral wool, typical)
- Ambient natural convection coefficient, $h = 1.5 \text{ Btu}/(\text{hr}\cdot\text{ft}^2\cdot^\circ\text{F})$ (typical outdoor, still air)

Step 1 — Set up the steady-state radial conduction/convection energy balance (per unit length):

Conduction through insulation = Convection from surface to ambient

$$2\pi k (T_{\text{pipe}} - T_{\text{surface}}) / \ln(r_2/r_1) = h \times 2\pi r_2 (T_{\text{surface}} - T_{\text{amb}})$$

Simplifies to:

$$k (T_{\text{pipe}} - T_{\text{surface}}) / \ln(r_2/r_1) = h \times r_2 \times (T_{\text{surface}} - T_{\text{amb}})$$

Step 2 — Substitute known values:

$$k (T_{\text{pipe}} - T_{\text{surface}}) = 0.032 \times (250 - 140) = 0.032 \times 110 = 3.52$$

$$h \times (T_{\text{surface}} - T_{\text{amb}}) = 1.5 \times (140 - 80) = 1.5 \times 60 = 90$$

$$3.52 / \ln(r_2/r_1) = 90 \times r_2$$

Step 3 — Solve iteratively for r_2 (with $r_1 = 0.276 \text{ ft}$):

Trial r_2 (ft)	$\ln(r_2/r_1)$	LHS = $3.52/\ln(r_2/r_1)$	RHS = $90 \times r_2$	Compare
0.30	0.0834	42.2	27.0	LHS > RHS
0.32	0.1479	23.8	28.8	LHS < RHS
0.313	0.1258	27.98	28.17	LHS $\approx$ RHS (converged)

$$r_2 \approx 0.313 \text{ ft} = 3.756 \text{ in}$$

Step 4 — Required insulation thickness:

$$\text{Insulation thickness} = r_2 - r_1 = 3.756 - 3.3125 \approx 0.443 \text{ in}$$

Result: The calculated minimum insulation thickness to bring the surface temperature down to the 140 °F touch-safety target is only **≈ 0.44 in** — however, standard insulation product thicknesses and mechanical/jacketing durability requirements typically mean a **practical minimum of 1 inch** is specified on the line list regardless of the thinner calculated requirement.

✦ **Assumption check:** This lumped, steady-state radial model ignores jacketing emissivity/radiation effects and assumes still-air convection — for outdoor, windy locations the effective h can be considerably higher (reducing required insulation thickness further) or the analysis may need a wind-speed-adjusted convection coefficient per the project's insulation design standard. Also confirm the project's touch-safety standard: some specify a shorter contact-duration basis (e.g., a 5-second momentary contact limit allows a higher surface temperature than the 140°F "any duration" basis used here).

10. Sample Datasheets

10.1 Sample Line List Table

Line No.	From → To	Size (NPS)	Piping Class	Fluid Service	Design P (psig)	Design T (°F)	Normal P/T	Insulation	PWHT	Test Pressure (psig)	Corr. Allow. (in)
6"-P-1042-A1A-H	P-101 A → V-200	6	A1A (CS, Cl.300)	Light HC liquid	310	200	100 psig / 150 °F	Personnel protection, 1"	No	465	0.0625
8"-P-1015-A1A	V-100 → P-101 A/B	8	A1A (CS, Cl.150)	Light HC liquid	165	175	20 psig / 100 °F	None	No	248	0.0625
4"-U-2031-B2B-T	Utility Header → K-101 Seal Pot	4	B2B (CS, Cl.150, sour)	Sweet fuel gas	285	250	250 psig / 150 °F	Hot, 1.5"	Yes	428	0.125
2"-P-1042-01-A1A	6"-P-1042 branch → PSV-115	2	A1A (CS, Cl.300)	Light HC liquid	310	200	100 psig / 150 °F	None	No	465	0.0625

(Illustrative — a real line list carries every line in the unit, with additional fields per the project's line list procedure: P&ID reference, stress-critical flag, sour service flag, PMI requirement, NDE percentage, etc.)

10.2 Piping Class Summary Datasheet

Piping Class	A1A	B2B
Base Material	ASTM A106 Gr. B, seamless (CS)	ASTM A106 Gr. B, seamless (CS), sour service qualified
Rating	ASME B16.5 Class 300	ASME B16.5 Class 150
Corrosion Allowance	0.0625 in (1.5 mm)	0.125 in (3 mm) — higher for sour/erosive service
Design Temperature Range	−20 °F to 400 °F	−20 °F to 400 °F
Gasket	Spiral wound, CS winding, graphite filler	Spiral wound, 316SS winding, graphite filler
Bolting	ASTM A193 B7 / A194 2H	ASTM A193 B7M / A194 2HM (sour service, NACE MR0175)
Valve Trim	Standard CS trim	Sour-service-qualified trim per NACE MR0175/ISO 15156
PWHT Requirement	Per B31.3 thickness/material thresholds	Mandatory for all welds (PMS override, sour service)
NDE Requirement	Per B31.3 category (normal fluid service)	100% RT (PMS override, sour service)
Impact Test Requirement	Per Calc Sheet 9.2 methodology, case-by-case	Per Calc Sheet 9.2 methodology, case-by-case

10.3 Line Designation / Numbering Legend

Code Position	Example	Meaning
Size prefix	6"	Nominal pipe size
Fluid code	P	Process
	U	Utility
	ST	Steam
	CW	Cooling water
Sequential number	1042	Unique within area/unit block (e.g., 1000–1999 = Unit 100)
Piping class	A1A	Ties to PMS (Section 10.2)
Suffix	H	Hot insulation
	C	Cold/personnel protection insulation
	T	Heat traced
	(none)	No insulation/tracing

11. Practical Design Checklist

- ☐ Line designation/numbering philosophy and PMS issued and approved (Section 1) before line list population begins
- ☐ Design pressure determined per the governing-case logic (equipment MAWP, dead-head, PSV set + margin, operating + margin) — see Calc Sheet 9.1
- ☐ Static head correction applied for any line with meaningful elevation change between its reference point and connected equipment
- ☐ Design temperature determined including startup/upset margin and any stagnant/no-flow solar-exposure case
- ☐ MDMT / impact-test exemption screened per ASME B31.3 methodology, using actual stress ratio, not skipped or assumed — see Calc Sheet 9.2
- ☐ Piping class assigned per the lowest-rated class that satisfies design P/T at the line's actual design temperature (not ambient)
- ☐ Wall thickness verified against the pressure design formula plus corrosion allowance and mill tolerance — see Calc Sheet 9.3
- ☐ Insulation type and thickness specified per actual requirement (process, personnel protection, or anti-sweat) — see Calc Sheet 9.4
- ☐ Heat tracing requirement and target maintain temperature flagged where applicable

- ☐ PWHT and NDE requirements flagged per material/thickness/service (including any PMS override for sour/critical service)
 - ☐ Stress-critical and hazardous-service flags populated for every line, not just the obviously large-bore ones
 - ☐ Line list formally linked to the source design-basis documents (process, relief, settle-out studies) so revisions to those studies trigger a controlled line list revision
 - ☐ Line list issued under change/revision control, with a clear audit trail from design basis to final as-built record
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12. Common Field Issues & Lessons Learned

Issue	Root Cause	Practical Fix
Wrong flange rating installed in the field (Class 150 where Class 300 required)	Line list design pressure was not updated after a pump curve/dead-head revision	Formally link line list design pressure fields to the source equipment datasheet revision, and trigger a line list re-check on any equipment datasheet revision
Unnecessary impact testing specified, adding cost/schedule	MDMT screening skipped or done without the stress-ratio reduction credit	Always apply the full B31.3 Fig. 323.2.2A/B methodology (Calc Sheet 9.2), not just the basic curve, before defaulting to impact-tested material
Personnel protection insulation omitted on an accessible hot line	Insulation requirement field left blank/defaulted rather than explicitly calculated per line	Require an explicit insulation calc or standard-detail reference for every accessible hot line above the touch-safety threshold, not a blanket assumption
Sour service PMS overrides missed on a branch line	Branch line inherited the parent line's class code without independent re-verification of service	Independently verify the fluid service and PMS class logic for every line, including small branches, rather than assuming inheritance is always correct
Line list and isometrics diverged during detailed engineering	Isometric revisions made informally without a corresponding controlled line list update	Enforce the line list as the master document — any isometric change affecting a line list field must trigger a line list revision, not the reverse
Static head effects on a long elevation-change line missed at FEED	Design pressure calculated only at a single nominal reference point without checking the full elevation profile	Explicitly check static head correction for any line with significant elevation change, in both directions of possible governing case (Calc Sheet 9.1 note)

13. Case Study — Stale Design Pressure Basis Causing a Flange Rating Mismatch

A composite, illustrative case study based on the type of finding commonly encountered during piping QA/QC review and hydrotest preparation. Names, tag numbers, and figures are representative, not project-specific.

13.1 Background

The illustrative pump discharge line from this guide (6"-P-1042-A1A-H, P-101 A/B to V-200) was originally line-listed at FEED using an early pump vendor's preliminary curve, which showed a rated differential of 220 psi and an assumed shutoff factor of 1.10 — giving an early dead-head estimate of $20 + (220 \times 1.10) = 262$ psig. Combined with the PSV set + 10% case (302.5 psig), the **PSV case governed** at that time, and the line was assigned Class 150 piping class (rated adequately for ~285 psig at the line's design temperature per B16.5).

13.2 Problem Identified

During detailed engineering, the pump vendor issued a final certified performance curve showing a higher rated differential (250 psi) and a confirmed shutoff factor of 1.15 — consistent with the Calc Sheet 9.1 example in this guide, giving a revised dead-head pressure of 307.5 psig, now **exceeding** the PSV case and governing the line design pressure. This revision was correctly captured in the process design basis and the pump datasheet, but the **line list was never updated** — the piping class remained listed as Class 150 (A1A rated to ~285 psig) through issue-for-construction.

The discrepancy was caught during **pre-hydrotest QA/QC review**, when the inspector cross-checked the installed Class 150 flanges against the (by-then-corrected) process design basis summary and found the installed rating did not cover the documented 307.5 psig design pressure.

13.3 Investigation & Recalculation

The piping engineering team reran the Calc Sheet 9.1 methodology using the final, certified pump curve data (the same numbers used in this guide's worked example) and confirmed: dead-head pressure = 307.5 psig, governing over the PSV + 10% case (302.5 psig) — meaning **Class 300** piping class was required, not the as-installed Class 150.

13.4 Root Cause

Two compounding root causes were identified:

1. **No formal trigger linking equipment datasheet revisions to line list re-verification** — the pump vendor's final curve revision was correctly routed to process engineering and the pump datasheet, but there was no procedural step requiring a corresponding line list check for any line whose design pressure basis depended on that equipment.
2. **Line list revision control gap** — the line list had been "frozen" for issue-for-construction based on the FEED-stage pump data, and the subsequent vendor data revision was treated as a pump-package-only update rather than triggering a piping design basis review.

13.5 Resolution

- The as-installed Class 150 flanges, valves, and fittings on the affected line segment (pump discharge to the first isolation point) were replaced with Class 300 components before hydrotest proceeded — caught before the line was put into

service, avoiding a safety-critical in-service failure, but still requiring field rework, re-procurement, and a schedule delay for the affected tie-in.

- The line list was formally revised, and a **design-basis traceability check** was added retroactively across the rest of the unit's line list to confirm no other lines had a similar stale-basis gap — none were found, but the check itself became a standard QA/QC step.
- The company's line list procedure was updated to require: any equipment datasheet revision affecting a connected line's design pressure/temperature basis **must** trigger an explicit line list re-verification, logged as a discrete checklist item in the MOC/revision record — not left to informal cross-discipline awareness.

13.6 Outcome

- The rework was contained to a single line segment and caught before commissioning, limiting the cost/schedule impact to several weeks rather than a post-startup failure — but the near-miss (a Class 150 flange rated below the actual required design pressure, discovered only at pre-hydrotest QA) was treated seriously as a process gap, not just a one-off paperwork error.
- The finding was documented as a corporate lessons-learned item: line list design conditions must be **formally, traceably linked** to their source equipment/process documents, with revision-triggered re-verification, rather than relying on the line list team's own tracking discipline alone.

13.7 Case-Specific Lessons Learned

Lesson	Applied Fix
A line list "frozen" for construction can silently go stale if its source design-basis documents are later revised	Require every equipment datasheet or process design-basis revision to trigger an explicit, logged line list re-verification for all dependent lines
The PSV-set-plus-margin case and the pump dead-head case can swap which one governs as vendor data firms up	Recalculate the governing design pressure case (Calc Sheet 9.1 method) whenever any input to it changes, not just at FEED
A rating mismatch can go undetected through fabrication and installation and only surface at hydrotest/QA review	Build a design-basis cross-check into the QA/QC pre-hydrotest procedure as a standard, not an ad hoc catch
Field rework after installation is far costlier than catching the same gap during detailed engineering	Treat the line list as a live, traceable document throughout detailed engineering, not a document that is finalized once and then only checked again at the very end

14. Reference Standards

- **ASME B31.3** — Process Piping (design pressure/temperature, wall thickness, MDMT/impact-test exemption methodology — Section 323 and Fig. 323.2.2A/B)
 - **ASME B16.5** — Pipe Flanges and Flanged Fittings (pressure-temperature ratings by class)
 - **ASME B16.34** — Valves — Flanged, Threaded, and Welding End
 - **ASME B36.10M** — Welded and Seamless Wrought Steel Pipe (standard schedule/wall thickness)
 - **API 5L** — Specification for Line Pipe
 - **NACE MR0175 / ISO 15156** — Materials for use in H₂S-containing environments (sour service piping class overrides)
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This guide is a practical study reference combining standard line list preparation methodology with worked sample calculations and lessons learned from real project experience. All numeric examples are illustrative — always validate against the project-specific Piping Material Specification (PMS), equipment vendor data, and the current edition of the referenced codes. This guide should be read alongside the companion Flare Network Design, Depressurization Calculation, and Compressor Settle-Out Calculations study guides, since the design pressures/temperatures those studies establish are exactly what the line list is built to carry forward.